

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Robin Banks

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Mona Lott** on strategy.
- **Barb Dwyer** has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- **Anne E. Dote** quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Robin Banks. I campaign for restitution. A disputed object does not become less disputed when somebody puts flowers beside it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Robin Banks

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Your other secret

You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Conversations to start

- Ask Mona Lott what the museum owes people represented in its collection.
- Ask Barb Dwyer what protest would get you removed from tonight's event.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A trophy is more than decoration tonight. Check below its foot.*
- 2 *Where red drapes close the scene, evidence waits out of sight.*
- 3 *A secret has been put on ice, quite literally.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I put the protest stickers in the brochures. Grant had already had me removed from another event and threatened legal action tonight. He wanted a room celebrating ownership without asking how the owner acquired it. The stickers were peaceful and intentional. I brought enough pens that nobody could claim the petition lacked a practical way to sign.

IF MURDERER

The brochure stickers are mine. Grant threatened another removal and a lawsuit if I disrupted the unveiling. He called questions about restitution harassment. I had been circulating the petition anyway. He could afford to delay an ownership case longer than the families seeking answers could afford to pursue one.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stayed at the return desk from 6:39 to 6:45 for the student group's live teach-in. I put stickers in brochures while explaining the shipping manifest. The whole-room stream kept running. Afterward I brought the petition back to the gallery. Grant had rejected it earlier without reading beyond the heading.

IF MURDERER

I supplied a recorded introduction to the student group and distributed brochures in the gallery before the toast. I had approached Grant early about the petition. He said the ownership file was closed. I was checking the manifest against the accession card so the next person repeating that claim could be asked which file they meant.



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Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I used linen to keep the glue off the worktable and borrowed the setup key for a brochure holder. The warning about returning what was taken was not my wording. My stickers say 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB.' Grant's lawyers would prefer it to be a subject nobody mentions at dinner.

IF MURDERER

I borrowed the setup key for the brochure holder and retained the glue cloth. My stickers say 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB.' I had marked the shipping chain on a copy of the manifest. Grant wanted me to give him that copy; he had no interest in giving the families the original ownership documents.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Robin Banks

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Tear off this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Robin Banks

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The protest was mine. The student group's retained return-desk stream keeps me there through the contamination interval. I wanted Grant alive to face an ownership claim he had spent years avoiding. My questions survive him, but I did not decide that his death would answer them.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I sent the students a recording while I moved through the gallery. The glue cloth carried stolen toxin to Grant's coupe. I wanted him unable to bury another restitution demand under a legal threat. I poisoned him instead of making him answer. The cause remains necessary. What I did in its name cannot be excused by it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.